Students conducting house-to-house survey of beneficiaries

phase was to end overlapping of multiple schemes to achieve the goal of "One Family—One Scheme". A unified DBT platform named Digital Infrastructure for DBT schemes (DIDS) was created to subsume multiple schemes for more efficient delivery and outcomes. The new beneficiaries began getting benefits from April 10, 2023.

The impact of the Orunodoi scheme has been acknowledged in several academic exercises within and outside the country. "From the scheme, all women of Assam especially rural widow, unmarried, separated from family member, physically handicap and disabled women are getting lots of benefits…. after all the Orunodoi scheme is an empowerment scheme for Assam, Assam's women and Assamese family," writes Ranjeeta Phukan of Vivekananda College in Delhi University in a study titled *Empowering Family with Empowering Women in Empowering Assam: A Case Study of Orunodoi Scheme in Baksa District.* In another study titled *Revaluing Unpaid Work: The Case of the Orunodoi Scheme in Assam*, Prabha Kotiswaran, professor of law at King's College, London, found that the scheme conferred dignity on women.



Students conducting house-to-house survey of beneficiaries

"…women expressed happiness that they could now spend on their own needs without having to ask for money from their sons or other men in the family," Kotiswaran wrote.

Undoubtedly, the Orunodoi scheme has emerged as a tectonic shift in the way the fruits of good governance are delivered and poverty alleviation programmes are run in the country. "We are simply following the path shown by Prime Minister Modiji. Development is meaningless if we cannot bring smiles to those at the bottom of the socio-economic pyramid," says Chief Minister Dr Sarma. ■

Students conducting house-to-house survey of beneficiaries



THE FOLLOWING CATEGORIES OF PEOPLE ARE GIVEN PRIORITY

- Households which has widow, divorced female, unmarried female, separated female and specially-abled member
- Poorer families irrespective of covered under National Food Security Act or not

THE FOLLOWING ARE EXCLUDED FROM THE SCHEME

- Current Members of Panchayati Raj institutions, urban local bodies and autonomous councils/VCDCs/VDCs (in 6th Scheduled districts)
- Household with any member serving or having served as an employee and/or officer in any government ministry, department or office and its field unit or any Central or State Public Sector Undertaking (PSU) or autonomous bodies under the Government or local government bodies or cooperative societies partially or fully funded by Government in a regular position
- Doctors, engineers, lawyers, chartered accountants, architects and registered government contractors
- Households having any individual who paid income tax in the previous Assessment Year (AY)
- Farmer families which own more than 15 bighas of agricultural land or/and one bigha or more residential land in rural area
- Households owning 1.5 kathas or more land in Kamrup Metro or 3 kathas or more in any other urban area, or owning industrial or commercial land irrespective of the quantum
- Household owning motorised four wheeler, including tractor
- Household having any government pensioner
- Househld owning an air conditioner